

European and North American countries at the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime that entered into force on July 1st, 2004.

When cyber crime took its roots

Since the beginning of the computer age, scientists and programmers have been working to find vulnerabilities in software and hardware products. When computer technology was relatively new, and networks were first gaining prominence in the 1990s, those who engaged in illegal hacking activities only did so to improve their knowledge of the systems that they were using, so that they could pit themselves against other competitors and be heralded as the better hacker. Thus, any highly dangerous activity such as intrusions into military installations or commercial organizations was perhaps nothing more than a nuisance. Since they weren't done with the intention of gaining profit, they didn't pose a long-term threat to security or raise concern to the level normally associated with criminal behaviour. Yet, as history pays testament, when people develop skills that give them some sort of an advantage over society, some of them will eventually use it to try to exploit and victimize society with their skill set. Enterprising criminals, aided by the massive growth in computer ownership and the financial transactions that take place throughout the internet, learned to exploit the vulnerabilities to commit cyber crime. This new breed of cybercriminal is no longer motivated solely by ego and tech ability. Cybercriminals have slowly discovered that the skills that they learnt as teens could now be used to make a comfortable living for themselves.

The effects of cyber crime on society

Studies show that on an average, more than one cyber crime occurs every 10 seconds. If that hit rate is not alarming enough, the fact that absolutely everyone is equally vulnerable to getting hit makes it worse. There have been recorded losses of over \$500 million in one year solely due to cyber crime. The need for drastic measures against cyber crime would become extremely clear once we observe the effects of cyber crime.

The crime is, basically, an attack on information about people or groups, and though the attack isn't physical (it's virtual), it's equally harmful. In a day and age where our virtual identities are just as important as our real identities, cyber criminals are mindful of the fact that all our personal information is centralised and we – the common man, our businesses, governments and properties – are extremely reliant on computers. Let's